Question Subtype Definitions

This article documents all Evaluation form question-subtype behaviors. It was created in response to a dependency identified while creating a PRD to update the UI of Evaluation forms for PI.26.4.
Written July 23, 2026

A subtype doesn't change what a question *looks like* — it decides **who is allowed to answer it**. Pick the subtype by thinking through who creates the form and who needs to respond.

Sources reconciled: Vector support article “Form Question Subtypes”+ TeachPoint form engine (code of record)

Start with two questions

Every subtype choice comes down to **who initiates the form** and **who should answer that particular question**. Find your row, read off the subtype.

Who initiates the form?	Who answers this question?	Use this subtype
Evaluee	The author (the initiator)	**Normal**
Evaluee	An evaluator	**Any Evaluator**
Evaluee	An evaluator with *view-only* permission	**Third Party**
Evaluator	The author (the initiator)	**Normal**
Evaluator	The evaluee	**Reflection**
Evaluator	An evaluator with *view-only* permission	**Third Party**
Either	Anyone who can record	**Anyone**
Either	No one — it's display text	**Read Only**

What each subtype means

The six subtypes you choose from in the form builder. “Author” = whoever initiated the form; “Record” and “View” refer to a user's permission level on that form.

Normal	Only the **author** — the person who created the form — can answer.	Author Only
Reflection	Only the **evaluee** (the person being evaluated) can answer. Used for self-reflection.	Evaluee Only
Third Party	Anyone with **View** permission — other than the author and evaluee — can answer. Typically secondary evaluators or supervisors.	View Permission
Any Evaluator	Any user with **Record** permission *except the evaluee* can answer.	Record (not evaluee)
Anyone	Any user with **Record** permission — *including the evaluee* — can answer.	Record Permission
Read Only	**No one** can answer. Used for instructions, headings, and examples.	Display Only

System-only

The form engine also has two subtypes you never pick by hand: `Auto` (populated by the system) and `Computed Only` (filled by a formula, and uniquely able to update *even after the form is locked*). They don't appear in the builder, so day-to-day users can ignore them

Which question types allow which subtypes

Not every subtype is available on every question type. ● = allowed. This is enforced by the form engine.

Question type	Normal	Reflection	Third Party	Any Eval.	Anyone	Read Only
Rating Scale	●	●	●	●	●	●
Text Entry	●	●	●	●	●	●
Choose One	●	●	●	●	●	●
Choose Any	●	●	●	●	●	●
Pass / Fail	●	●	●	●	●	●
Date	●	●	●	●	●	●
Time	●	●	●	●	●	●
DateTime	●	●	●	●	●	●
Timer	●	●	●	●	●	●
Duration	●	●	●	●	●	●
Signature	●	●	●	●	●	–
Signature (Non-locking)	●	●	●	●	●	–
Computed	●	●	●	●	●	–
Script	●	–	–	●	●	–
Video	●	–	–	●	●	–
Heading	–	–	–	–	–	●
Instructions	–	–	–	–	–	●

Note

Computed questions also support the system-only `Computed Only` subtype (not shown above, since it isn't chosen in the builder).

Three rules worth remembering

- **1 Headings & Instructions are always Read Only.** They're labels and directions — never answered by anyone.
- **2 Signatures can't be Read Only.** A signature has to be actionable by someone, so display-only doesn't apply.
- **3 “Normal” follows the initiator.** Normal always means *the author answers* — so on an evaluee-initiated form, Normal is answered by the evaluee, not the evaluator.

Signatures use the same logic

For a signature question, swap “who answers?” for **“who signs?”** — the subtype is chosen exactly the same way.

Who initiates the form?	Who signs?	Signature subtype
Evaluee	The evaluee	**Normal**
Evaluee	An evaluator	**Any Evaluator**
Evaluee	A view-only evaluator	**Third Party**
Evaluator	The evaluee	**Reflection**
Evaluator	An evaluator	**Normal**
Evaluator	A view-only evaluator	**Third Party**

Additional Materials:

1. Form subtype support center article